

IN TEST: 21 INKJET PRINTERS



For ardent fans of the world of ink and paper, vivid colours and breathtaking resolutions are now within reach, with a plethora of inkjet printers to choose from

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From stunning greeting cards to your housing society's newsletter, today's inkjet printers are capable of some of the most realistic images and sharp text printouts today.

Printer technology has not really witnessed as drastic a change as that seen in other realms of computing such as 3D graphics processing, but it has seen a very significant drop in terms of the technology available for a given price.

Until about six months ago, for instance, 1440 dpi printing was imaginable only in the professional printing segment, and home and SoHo users had to be content with a 600 dpi resolution. However, today's printing technology lets even home users enjoy full colour printing at high densities, and at prices that put inkjet-printing technology within the reach of most home users.

TEST PROCESS

The test system consisted of a Celeron 466-based computer with 128 MB SDRAM, a 440BX-based motherboard, and a 20 GB Seagate U8 IDE hard disk. Since the performance of the printers also depends on the interface, we configured the parallel port to operate using the ECP+EPP mode. The USB ports were also enabled on the system to support printers that featured this interface.

We loaded Windows 98 SE on a cleanly formatted system and mapped the image of the drive with the OS and all the drivers loaded. This image was restored after each printer was tested so as to eliminate any interference from previously loaded printer drivers.

Each of the printers was subjected to a range of tests that evaluated their performance on two basic parameters—printing speed and image quality. For ascertaining the print speed, we used a sample document file that consisted of five



More Info on the test process and the products tested, check out **Mindware**

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